

YICHEN WANG

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🎓 EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

PhD, Department of Computer Sciences

- advised by Prof. Yudong Chen

Madison, US

2025.9 -

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

BS, Department of Automation

Shanghai, CHN

2021.9 - 2025.6

University of Warwick

Visiting Student, Department of Computer Science

Coventry, UK

2024.9 - 2024.12

RESEARCH INTEREST

My research interest currently lies in statistical learning theory, focuses on developing a theoretical understanding of modern machine learning systems, using tools from high-dimensional statistics.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Yichen Wang**, Yudong Chen, Lorenzo Rosasco and Fanghui Liu. **The Shape of Generalization through the Lens of Norm-based Capacity Control**. *39th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2025.
[TLDR: We precisely characterize how the generalization learning curve behaves under a suitable model capacity and rigorously prove (Fig. 8.12, CS229 Lecture Notes).]
- **Yichen Wang**, Qiming Liu, Zhe Liu, and Hesheng Wang. **Enhancing Exploratory Capability in Visual Navigation using Uncertainty of Implicit Scene Representations**. *37th IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, 2024. (Oral)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Statistical learning theory

Advisor: Prof. Fanghui Liu, Prof. Yudong Chen. 2024.4 - 2025.1

- Derived deterministic equivalents for the ℓ_2 norm of the estimator in well-specified ridge regression and random feature ridge regression through random matrix theory and high dimensional statistics.
- Studied the relationship between test risk and the ℓ_2 norm of the estimator in the above two models and provided an affirmative answer to the existence of double descent, theoretically and empirically. Reshaped the corresponding scaling laws under norm-based capacity.
- Proposed a rethinking of the data-parameter paradigm, shifting the focus from parameter count to the norms (weights), and examining the transition from under-parameterized to over-parameterized regimes.
- This work has led to one publication: **Re-examining Double Descent and Scaling Laws under Norm-based Capacity via Deterministic Equivalence**.

Robot visual navigation

Advisor: Prof. Hesheng Wang. 2022.9 – 2023.11

- Designed an end-to-end visual navigation framework utilizing NeRF as a memory mechanism, extending NeRF's efficient and compact scene representation from the perception domain to the control domain, and bridging the gap between exploration and navigation through uncertainty estimation.
- This work has led to one publication on IROS'24 (oral presentation).

AWARDS & HONORS

- **National First Prize**, "TI Cup" China Undergraduate Electronics Design Contest. (Top1%) 2023
- **Shanghai Outstanding Graduate**. (Top5%) 2025
- **Second Price**, Academic Scholarship of Shanghai Jiao Tong University 2023, 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- CS 200: Programming I —Teaching Assistant, UW-Madison

Fall 2025

REFERENCES

- **Yudong Chen**
 - Associate Professor at Department of Computer Sciences, UW-Madison, USA.
 - `yudong.chen@wisc.edu`
- **Fanghui Liu**
 - Assistant Professor at Department of Computer Science, University of Warwick, UK.
 - `fanghui.liu@warwick.ac.uk`
- **Xiaolin Huang**
 - Full Professor at Department of Automation, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China.
 - `xiaolinhuang@sjtu.edu.cn`